

SCHOOLFEES MANAGER

User Guide

Payments Module

Record payments, print receipts, and handle reversals

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1. Overview

The Payments module records every naira a student pays. It auto-calculates outstanding balance, generates printable and SMS receipts, and posts to the accounting module if it is enabled. Reversals are supported with an audit trail.

2. Posting a Payment

1. In the sidebar, click **Payments -> Post Payment**.
2. Search for the student by name or reg number, or click **Quick Pick** to see the class roster.
3. The student's outstanding balance for the current term appears at the top right. Review it.
4. Enter the **Amount Paid**. The system will accept partial payments — the balance updates after.
5. Pick the **Payment Date** (defaults to today) and **Method** (Cash, Bank Transfer, POS, Cheque).
6. For bank transfers and cheques, enter the **Reference** (transaction ID, cheque number, or POS terminal slip number) so you can reconcile later.
7. Click **Post Payment**.
8. A receipt preview appears with a unique receipt number (e.g., RCP-2024-0123). Click **Print** to send to the printer or **SMS Receipt** to text the parent (if SMS is configured).

TIP

Always print or text the receipt before closing the window. If you forget, you can re-print from **Payments -> Payment History** by clicking the receipt number.

Receipt numbering

Receipts follow the format RCP-YYYY-NNNN where YYYY is the year and NNNN is the sequence. The sequence is global and never reuses a number, even across years. Reversals use the prefix REV- to keep them distinct in reports.

3. Viewing Payment History

1. Click **Payments -> Payment History** in the sidebar.
2. Filter the list using the controls at the top: date range, payment method, class, or student name.
3. Click any row to see the full receipt with line-by-line bill breakdown.
4. Use the **Export Excel** button to download a spreadsheet of the filtered list — useful for end-of-day cash reconciliation.

4. Reversing a Payment

Mistakes happen — wrong student, wrong amount, double entry. The system supports payment reversal which keeps the original record but cancels its effect on the balance.

1. Open Payments -> Payment History.

2. Find the payment to reverse and click the **red Reverse icon at the right of the row.**

3. A confirmation box asks for a **Reversal Reason (required — e.g., "Duplicate entry", "Wrong student").**

4. Type the reason and click **Confirm Reversal.**

5. A reversal receipt is generated (REV-YYYY-NNNN). The original payment stays in history marked as Reversed, and the student's balance is restored.

IMPORTANT

Reversals cannot be undone. If you reverse a real payment by mistake, post a new payment with the same details and add a note in the Reference field linking to the cancelled receipt.

NOTE

Only Admin and Bursar roles can reverse payments. Viewers can only see history.

5. End-of-Day Reconciliation

Reconcile your physical cash and bank deposits with the system every evening. This catches errors early.

1. Click **Payments -> Payment Audit** in the sidebar.
2. Filter by **Today's Date** and **Posted By** (your username).
3. The page shows: Total Cash, Total Transfer, Total POS, Total Cheque.
4. Count your physical cash drawer. It should match the **Total Cash** figure.
5. Check your bank app or POS terminal slip total against the relevant totals.
6. If anything is off, open Payment History and look for any unusual entries. Reverse and re-post if needed.
7. Click **Print Day Summary** at the top to keep a paper record signed by the bursar.

6. Common Payment Scenarios

Parent pays part now, rest later	Just enter the amount paid today. The system shows the new outstanding balance on the receipt. When they pay the rest, post another payment.
Parent pays for two children at once	Post one payment per child. You can split the bank amount however the parent specifies, or evenly. Each child gets their own receipt.
Parent pays in advance for next term	Post the payment in the current term. The credit balance shows up as a Credit on the student's profile and is automatically applied when next term's bills are generated.
Wrong amount posted	Reverse the payment with reason "Amount correction", then post the correct amount.
Receipt printed but parent paid less	Reverse the original and post the correct amount. Keep the wrong receipt stub stapled to the day's reconciliation sheet.